16. How China Sees India and the World: The Years of Transformation

The three Resolutions of the CPC, described in the previous chapter, trace the role of the CPC as an agency of China's transformation in the contemporary era. In its own words, the Party has, in the past 100 years, enabled China in successive phases to stand up, get rich, and now to become strong. These three phases roughly correspond to the Mao Zedong era (1949–76), the Deng Xiaoping era (1978–2012) and the current Xi Jinping era (2012–). Although Deng died in 1997, his policy line was continued and expanded by his successors Jiang Zemin and Hu Jintao.

However, a key turning point in China's view of the world was the global financial and economic crisis of 2008, when the Chinese leadership sensed a change in what they describe as the international balance of power. The US and its Western allies were seen as having experienced a severe economic setback. The American model of free markets and liberal democracy, often termed as the Washington Consensus, had lost its allure. China, on the other hand, had made a quick recovery from the crisis and resumed its high-growth trajectory. This had created an opportunity for China to advance its interests and gain at the expense of its chief rival, the US. China no longer had to 'hide its light and bide its time', as directed by Deng Xiaoping. The time had come for a fresh directive: *Fengfa Youwei* , translated as 'Striving for Achievement'.

This shift in direction, which first appeared in 2009, was reinforced when Xi Jinping became the party leader in 2012, and is reflected in the most recent third Party History Resolution of 2021. This final phase is encompassed in the realization of the 'China Dream' and the 'great rejuvenation of the Chinese nation'. These terms were first used as formal slogans in 2012, when Xi Jinping used them in connection with the 'two centenary goals' – the 100th anniversary of the establishment of the CPC in